

Title: Are lower elo players really that mechanically good?

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

To preface, I'm a mid master mid lane player, and a low GM support player. And I'm currently playing on a top lane account to beat the e-girl allegations. It's been a few years since I've played in an elo lower than diamond (solo/duo, at least), plat 1 right now, and like... laning feels *hard*. I'm still 'winning' lane through wave management and macro, but mechanically, I'm only coming out on top ~60% of the time, and it's almost never a stomp.

As a player, I sort of pride myself as being mechanically good, at least I thought. While I don't know the ins and outs of each lane matchup like a master player would, I've still been playing the game for ~7 years, and feel like I should be performing much better for being a master player. I know top lane is a lot more punishing, but that's not even the problem I have (I think), because when I am out-traded, they often don't setup the wave in a way that can *really* fuck me up... it's just that, I'm losing the trade in the first place.

Idk, genuinely curious if it's just a me thing and I'm bad, or if lower elo players are really just like that, cause I'm just getting major imposter syndrome about being a master midlaner atm TvT. (Obv. imposter syndrome about being a GM support, but that's just true lol).

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 246]

Low elo is a mixed bag where people have different strengths and weaknesses.

Some are really good mechanically while being super bad at macro and vice versa.

[Comment 2 | Score: 250]

As a returning player starting a new account I was surprised how good some of the silver players were mechanically. I think it's easy for someone with decent mechanics but terrible macro to be stuck in Silver

[Comment 3 | Score: 57]

Yes, around plat/emerald players are good mechanically. There are two things though

1) The 'mechanically impressive' play isn't always the best one to make. More often than not, lower elo players will make a riskier play because they can, but probably shouldn't.

2) They often lack the macro to go out with their skills. There are a lot of early stomp games that should end in 25 minutes and just gets dragged and allows comebacks.

[Comment 4 | Score: 19]

yeah man.

Game is old. Most players have been playing for years, even if they're low elo. Mechanical skill is easier to pick up than strategically correct play. A lot of low elo players just want 'kill go brrrr' and look for dopamine plays.

I hadn't really played in 5 or more years. Came back in Bronze V MMR. Was like plat 1 when I quit before. I was used to bronze being a cakewalk. Players being pretty much bots you could stomp mechanically and just take over the game without much thought. Jesus if it wasn't different now. Was instantly laning vs irelia's, riven's, etc who were insane at the game. My mechanics were rusty, but

they're gradually getting better again and I'm climbing through sheer macro. But god it was a shock to see how good some of these solo laners were. Often I got counterpicked, and years ago, I could outplay the matchup (OTP), and win. Now no one falls for it and they play it perfectly. Its nuts.

[Comment 5 | Score: 31]

The nature of top lane is that you get punished much harder for bad trades and mechanics.

I find that top lane players are quite a bit better at these things than mid laners, who can often nullify interaction through wave clearing and roaming. So that's one thing to keep in mind.

People also tend to pick early-game skewed spam-fight champions in low elo. Are you playing something that's strong at trading and skirmishes, or are you playing a scaler?

I don't think low elo players are necessarily "good" mechanically, they just surpass the bar for not fucking up a bunch, and so you can't really mechanics gap them unless you do something out of pocket.